Kærvej 83 detecting permission report

Kærvej 83, 7650 Bøvlingbjerg (Fåre) · 13 October 2026 · Mark

Summary

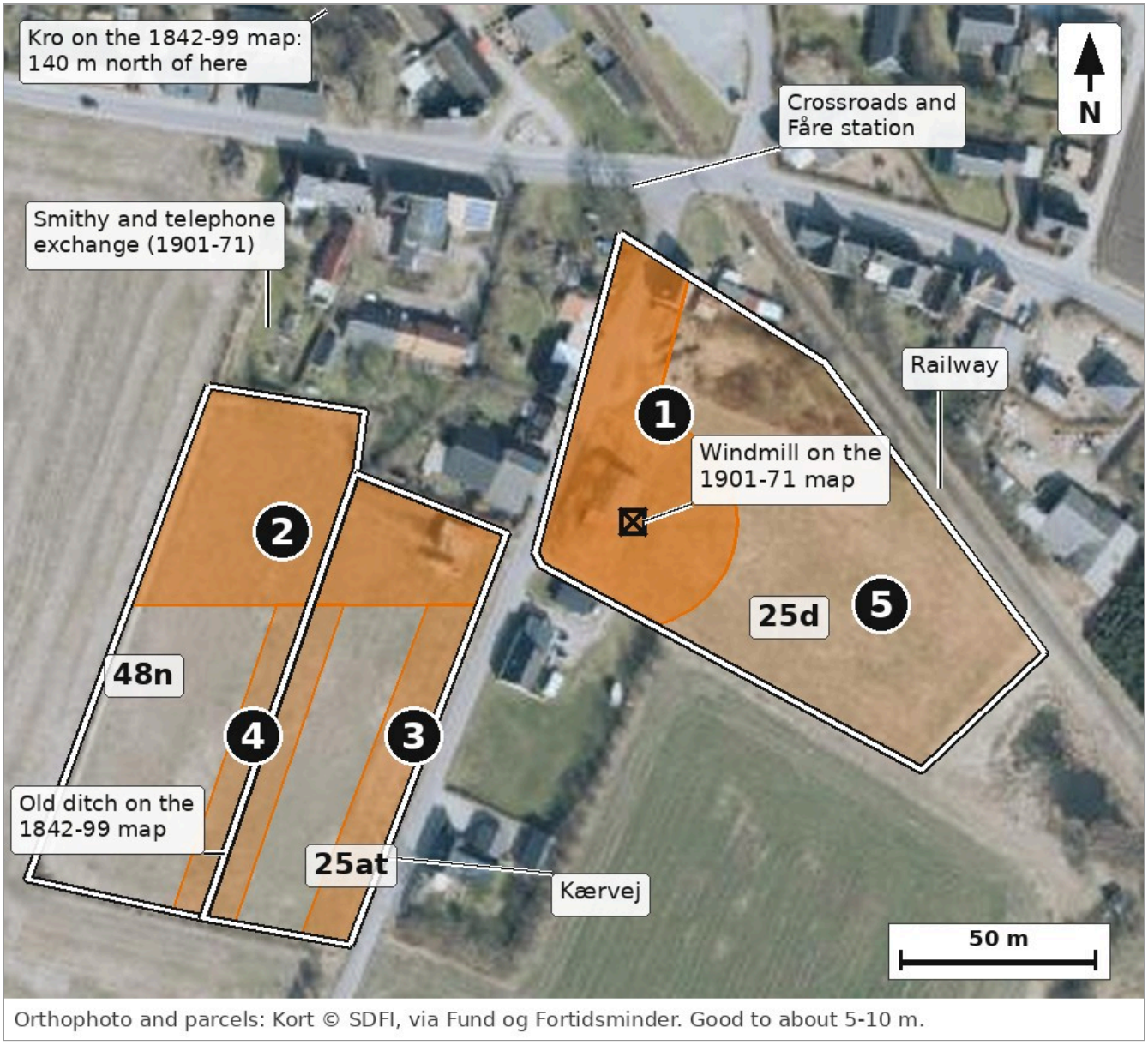
The permission is three parcels, about 2 ha in all, on the southern edge of Fåre in Bøvling parish. Two of them (48n and 25at) lie west of Kærvej; the third (25d) lies between Kærvej and the railway. The ground belonged to two old mill farms, Fåre Mølle (named in 1614) and Møllegård (named in 1595). It touches a crossroads that had an inn on the 1842-99 map, and a windmill, a smithy and a railway station by about 1900. Around it lies one of the denser prehistoric landscapes in the parish. It is a good small permission. Expect 1700s to 1900s village and mill losses, and keep an eye out for prehistoric flint and bronze.

- **Start on 25d by the windmill site.** The 1901-71 map draws a windmill in the west part of 25d, 15 to 20 m from Kærvej. The north tip of the parcel is 15 m from the crossroads.
- **Then the north ends of 48n and 25at.** They border the village plots where the 1901-71 map names a smithy and a telephone exchange, and the inn stood 140 m to the north.
- **Then the Kærvej frontage** of 25at, an old road on both old maps.
- **No protected monuments** lie on or beside the parcels. The nearest recorded site is a flint dagger findspot 150 m away; three ploughed-out barrows and a Neolithic settlement lie 240 to 300 m away.
- **To settle first:** whether the fields are ploughed or grass, and whether the owner allows digging along the road verge.

Positions on the detailed map are good to about 5 to 10 m, and on the old maps to about 10 to 15 m.

Map

Numbers run from the first place to search (1) to the last (5); the reasons are in Areas and plan below. White lines are the three parcels.



Map 1. Areas of interest, numbered in search order.

Parcel	Size	Where	Today
48n	about 0.6 ha	West strip, about 180 m by 35 m	Pale grass or stubble on the photo
25at	about 0.45 ha	Strip along the west side of Kærvej	Pale grass or stubble; a small outbuilding at its north-east corner
25d	about 0.9 ha	Between Kærvej and the railway, north tip at the crossroads	Rough grass with a disturbed patch near the north end

- **Address:** Kærvej 83, 7650 Bøvlingbjerg (Fåre). Ejerlav Den nordlige Del, Bøvling; Bøvling parish, Lemvig Kommune. The house itself stands on its own small plot (7000p), not in the permission.
- **Height:** about 9 m above sea level at the house.
- **Sizes** are measured from my tracing of the parcel lines and are good to about 10%.

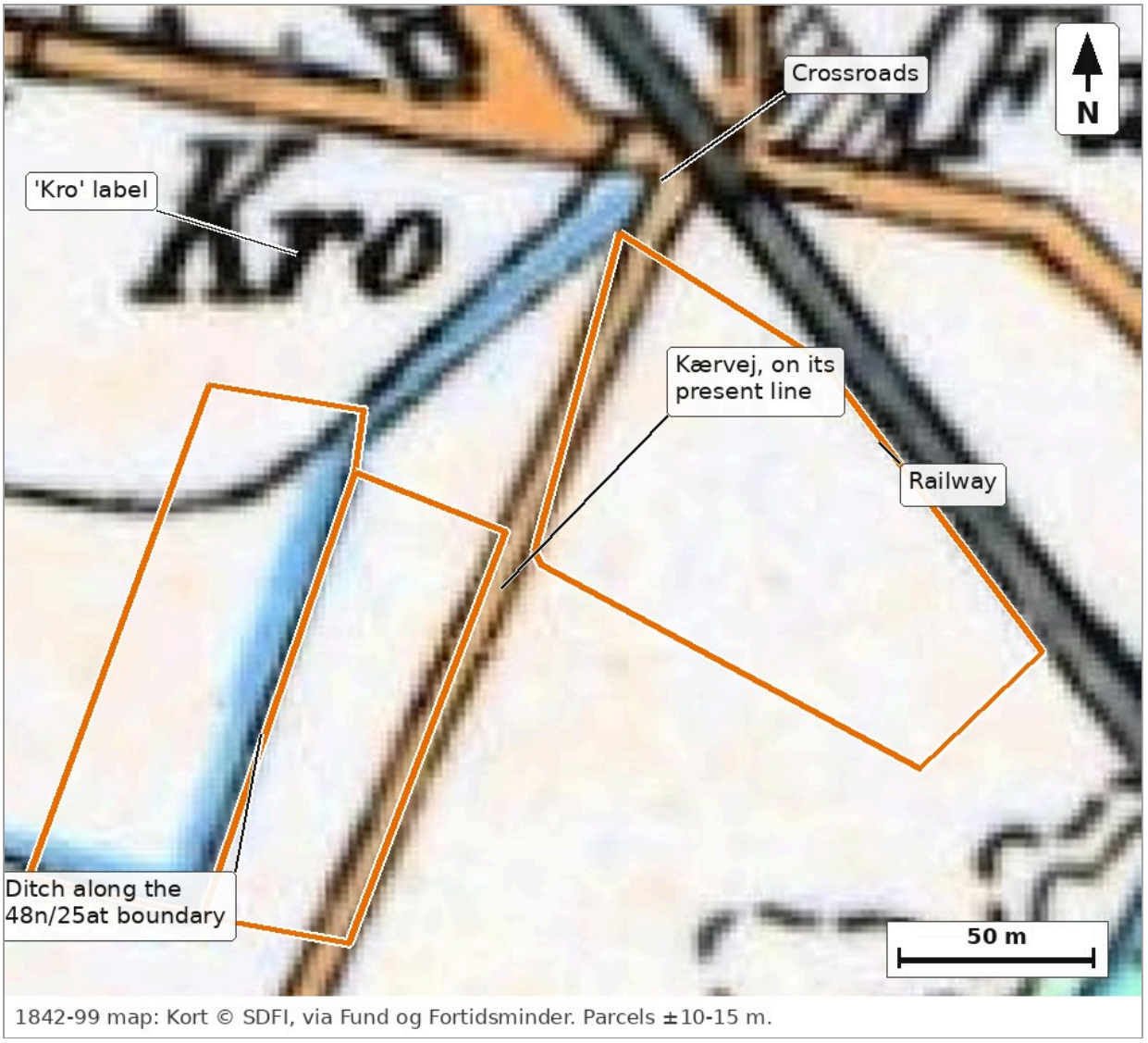
History of the area

Fåre grew from a cluster of old farms into a small station town after the railway came. Your parcels lie at the point where the old roads, the mill and the railway met.

- **Fåre.** The name is recorded as Foere in 1545 and Faar in 1574. Today it is a small station town on the Vemb-Lemvig-Thyborøn railway, 14 km south of Lemvig. The station stands at the crossroads, just north-east of 25d.
- **The mill farms.** Trap Danmark lists Fåre Mølle (1614 Faarmølle) and Møllegård (1595 Møllegaardt) among the parish's farms. National Museum surveyors in 1879 wrote of mounds on 'Faaremölles Mark, Matr. No 48' and 'Möllegaards Mark, Matr. No 25'. Your parcels carry the same numbers (48n, 25at and 25d), so they were part of these two farms' land.
- **The mills.** Fåre Mølle was a watermill on Fåremølle Å. The 1901-71 map names the mill farm 'Faaremølle' beside the stream about 150 m south-east of 25d, just east of the railway. It shows a mill pond and an electricity works (Elektrv) next to it. Christian V's land register lists 'Faar Mølle' as a separate holding in 1688, and the farm name goes back to 1614. The windmill drawn on 25d was a later addition: it is not on the 1842-99 map. A local history summary says a windmill was built in the 1800s to supplement the watermill, that the site also had a sawmill and made starch, dyes and bone meal, and that milling stopped around 1930. I have not checked those details against a primary source.
- **Traffic between the mills.** Carts going to and from the watermill and the windmill used Kærvej and the road past the crossroads, which adds to the chance of coins and harness losses along the road side of 25at and 25d.
- **The inn.** The 1842-99 map prints 'Kro' beside a building just north-west of the crossroads, about 140 m north of 25at. Inns at crossroads were stopping points for carters and drovers, and they spread small change into the ground round them.
- **Smithy and telephone exchange.** The 1901-71 map names a smithy (Smedie) and a telephone exchange (Tlfst) in the buildings just north of 48n.
- **Heather-meal factory.** A large factory for grinding heather into fodder was built 'at Fåre' in 1918 and burned down the next year. I have not found where it stood.
- **The older landscape.** West and north-west of Fåre lay open heath with barrows and Iron Age field systems, many of them now ploughed out. Settlements of the Neolithic, Bronze Age and Iron Age have been found within a kilometre (see Recorded archaeology).

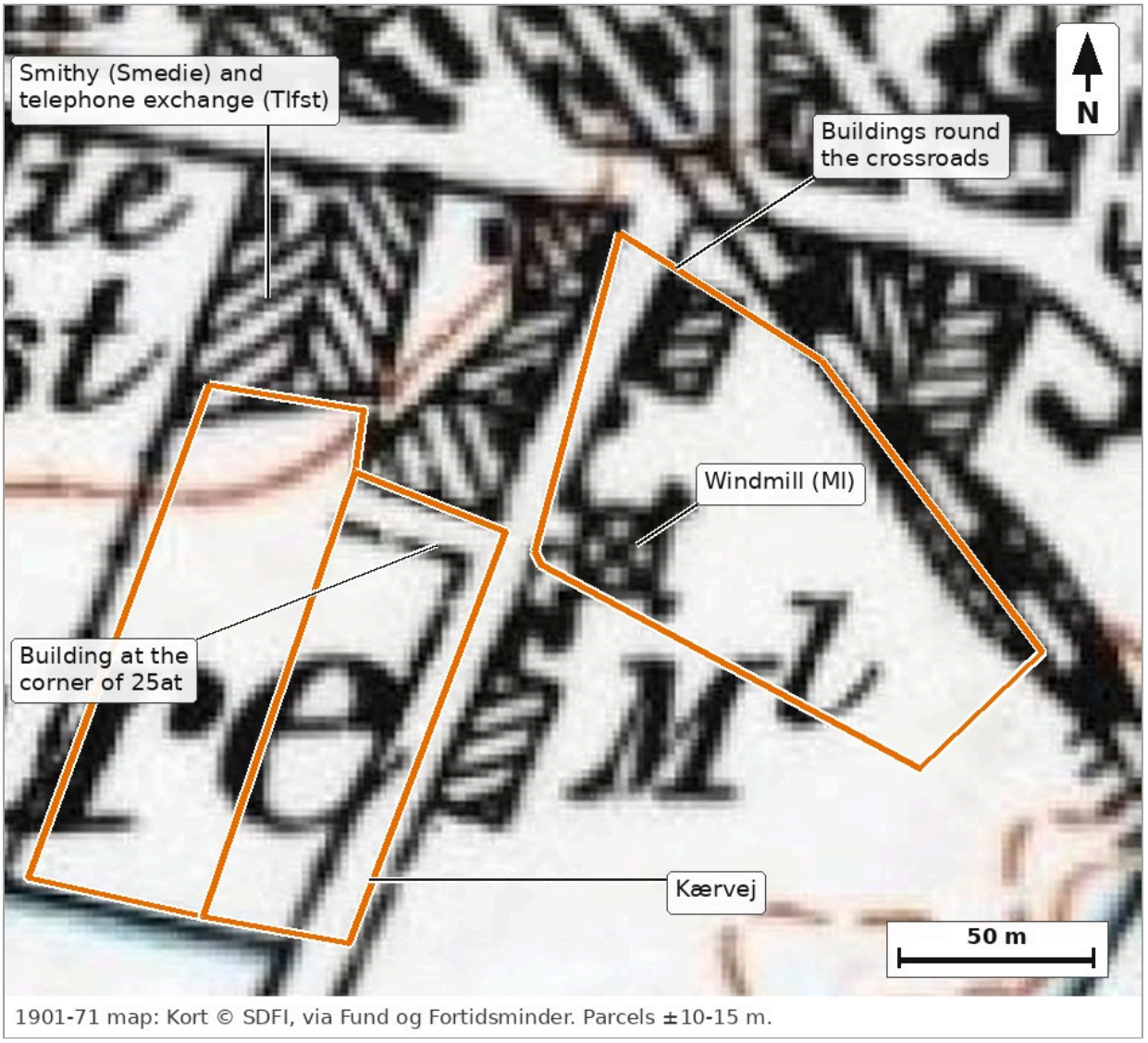
What the old maps show

Both maps fit today's roads closely. Kærvej runs on its present line on both, and the parcel lines follow old boundaries.



Map 2. The 1842-99 map (høje målebordsblade) with the parcels outlined.

- **Kærvej** is drawn as a road on its present line on both maps. It meets the east-west road at the crossroads by the north tip of 25d.
- **The ditch.** The 1842-99 map draws a blue watercourse exactly on the boundary between 48n and 25at. It runs north-east to the crossroads. The parcel line is therefore an old farm boundary, probably between Fåre Mølle's and Møllegård's land.
- **The inn.** The 'Kro' label sits just west of the crossroads; its building is the hatched one north of the road.
- **No buildings** stand on the parcels on this map.
- **The railway** already crosses the sheet, so this sheet was drawn or revised after the line opened.

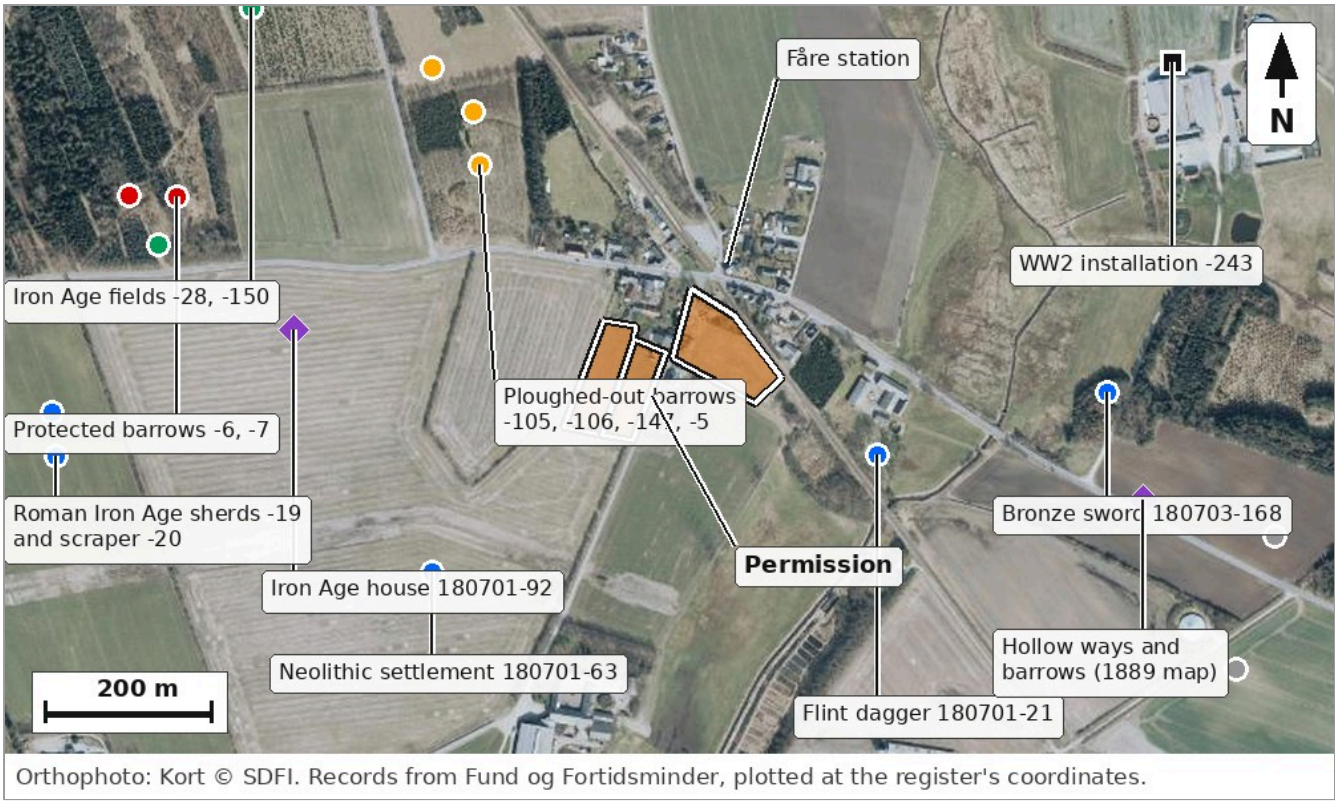


Map 3. The 1901-71 map (lave målebordsblade) with the parcels outlined.

- **The windmill.** A square symbol with a cross and the letters 'Ml' (Mølle) stands in the west part of 25d, 15 to 20 m east of Kærvej.
- **A building at the corner of 25at.** A hatched building straddles the north-east corner of 25at, where a small outbuilding stands today.
- **The village** has grown round the crossroads and the station, with the smithy and telephone exchange just north of 48n.
- **Fields** west of Kærvej are open, with the same boundary lines as today.

Recorded archaeology

Nothing is recorded on the parcels, and no protected monument lies within 500 m. The register holds 31 records within about a kilometre, almost all prehistoric. These are the nearest.



Map 4. The permission in its setting, with recorded localities at the register's coordinates.

Record	What it is	Date given	Distance
180701-21	Findspot of a flint dagger (Lemvig Museum 322)	Late Neolithic, 2350 to 1701 BC	150 m south-east
180701-63	Neolithic settlement: a thin-butted axe and part of a serrated spearhead	3950 to 1701 BC	240 m south-west
180701-147	Round barrow seen on air photos	Prehistoric	240 m north-west
180701-106 and -105	Ploughed-out barrows seen on air photos	3950 to 1101 BC	300 and 370 m north-west
180701-92	Iron Age house, a dark crop mark on air photos of 1966 and 2008	AD 1 to 174	350 m west
180703-168	Findspot of a flange-hilted bronze sword (Lemvig Museum 323)	Early Bronze Age, 1700 to 1101 BC	390 m east
180701-5	Small barrow on Fåre Mølle's land, broken up by 1879 and levelled by 1943	Prehistoric	440 m north-west
180701-150, -151, -28	Iron Age field systems (oldtidsagre)	500 BC to AD 374	510 to 570 m north-west
180701-6, -7	Protected barrows on Møllegård's old land	Prehistoric	530 to 590 m west
180701-19	Gravelly patch with Roman Iron Age potsherds, probably a settlement	AD 1 to 374	610 m west

- **A busy prehistoric landscape.** Barrows, field systems, settlements and single finds of every period from the Neolithic to the Iron Age lie in a ring 150 to 900 m round the permission. The ground you have is on the edge of it, not in the middle.

- **The flint dagger and the Neolithic settlement** are the closest. Both point to people living and farming on this low ground in the Neolithic, so flint on the surface is worth watching for.
- **The bronze sword** is a high-status find. A single sword is often a deliberate deposit, and it shows that Bronze Age metal does survive in these fields.
- **The Iron Age house and longhouses** (one 350 m west, a group found in 2023 at 875 m) show farms of the centuries round the birth of Christ. Iron Age brooches and pottery are possible on any well-drained field here.
- **Newer records:** two Second World War installations seen on 1954 air photos (600 and 930 m east), and hollow ways 460 m east.

Areas and plan

The windmill site and the crossroads end of 25d rank first, because a mill was a place where farmers came, waited and paid. Numbers match the first map.

Rank	Area	Why	How to search
1	West part of 25d: the windmill site and the strip up to the crossroads	Windmill on the 1901-71 map; the north tip lies 15 m from the crossroads, the station and the old inn	Tight lanes round the mill site; expect iron, brick and millstone fragments, and dig the non-ferrous signals
2	North ends of 48n and 25at, about 50 m deep	Next to the village plots, the smithy and the telephone exchange; 140 m from the inn	Lanes parallel to the north boundary; household rubbish spread from the gardens
3	Kærvej frontage of 25at	An old road on both maps; the 1901-71 building at the north-east corner	One or two lanes along the road, avoiding the verge drain
4	The old ditch on the 48n/25at boundary	A watercourse on the 1842-99 map and an old farm boundary	Work both sides; finds thrown up when it was dug or cleaned
5	The rest of 25d, towards the railway	Mill land, but further from the buildings; railway ballast and cinder near the line	Wide lanes first, then tighten if it produces

- **Unranked ground.** The open middle of 48n and 25at should give a thin manuring scatter. Walk it with your eyes down for flint as well: the Neolithic settlement and the flint dagger findspot are only 150 to 240 m away.
- **The disturbed patch** near the north end of 25d on the air photo may be recent dumping or a building site. Ask the owner what it is before giving it time.

First 10 hours

1. **Hours 1 to 3: area 1.** Tight lanes about 1.5 m apart round the windmill site, then up the strip to the crossroads.
2. **Hours 3 to 5: area 2.** Lanes along the north ends of 48n and 25at.
3. **Hours 5 to 6: area 3.** The Kærvej frontage.
4. **Hours 6 to 7: area 4.** Both sides of the old ditch line.
5. **Hours 7 to 9: sampling.** Wide lanes about 10 m apart across the rest of all three parcels, to see where finds thin out. Walk for flint at the same time.
6. **Hour 10: go back** to the best spot and tighten the lanes.

Log every non-ferrous find with a GPS point, including buttons and scrap. The pattern is what shows where the mill and the old buildings were busiest.

What to expect

Post-medieval finds are near certain, and the prehistoric chance is better than usual for a village-edge permission. The figures are my judgment from the evidence above, not measured rates.

Period	Chance of a datable find	Typical finds
1800s to early 1900s	Near certain	Skilling and øre coins, buttons, buckles, harness fittings, horseshoe fragments, clay pipe, railway and mill ironwork
1536 to 1800	Likely	Skilling coins of Christian IV to Christian VII, lead cloth seals, thimbles, shoe buckles
Medieval (about 1050 to 1536)	Possible	Pennies, buckles, strap ends, legs from bronze cooking pots
Iron Age	10 to 20%	Brooches, pottery, iron slag
Bronze Age	5 to 15%	Bronze fragments; a sword has been found 390 m away
Neolithic	Surface flint likely; metal none	Flint flakes, scrapers, axe and dagger fragments

- **Mill finds.** Expect lead and copper-alloy scrap, nails, iron fittings and pieces of millstone round the mill site. Coins lost by farmers waiting for their grain are the prize.
- **Village edge.** Fields next to houses get kitchen rubbish and ash spread on them, so expect a thick scatter of modern junk along the north ends.
- **Flint.** Look for worked flint on the surface after ploughing or rain, especially on 48n and 25at. Bag it with a GPS point; flint finds help the museum map the Neolithic settlement.

Rules, limits and open questions

Rules

- **Permission.** Keep the owner's agreement current, and check it covers all three parcels (48n, 25at and 25d).
- **Protected monuments.** Detecting is not allowed on a protected monument or within 2 m of it. None lies on or beside the permission.
- **Railway.** Stay off the railway land along the east side of 25d.
- **Danefæ and recording.** Register finds in DIME with a GPS point and the matrikel number. The responsible museum is De Kulturhistoriske Museer i Holstebro Kommune.
- **Depth.** Stay in the plough layer. If you meet dark soil, burnt stone, pottery or several finds together, stop and tell the museum.
- **Ammunition.** Two Second World War installations lie 600 to 930 m east. Leave anything suspicious and call 114.

Limits

- **Old-map readings are mine.** The windmill, the building at the corner of 25at and the ditch are read from scanned maps placed to about 10 to 15 m.
- **Record positions are the register's coordinates.** Older records (1879 to 1944) can be tens of metres out.
- **The flint dagger findspot.** Its register point falls on the Fåremølle farm buildings by the stream, so it may record where the dagger was handed in rather than exactly where it was found.

Open questions

- [ ] Ask the owner whether the fields are ploughed or grass, and what the disturbed patch on 25d is.
- [ ] Ask the owner or Lemvig Museum when the windmill on 25d was built and pulled down.
- [ ] Check the earliest cadastral map (about 1800 to 1820) for the mill and the inn.
- [ ] Ask Lemvig Museum whether anyone has looked at the flint dagger and Neolithic settlement findspots since 1943.

Sources

- Kærvej 83, DanskAdresseAPI: matrikel, ejerlav, parish and height.
- Bøvling Sogn, Trap Danmark 5th edition: Fåre, Fåre Mølle, Møllegård, the heather-meal factory, and the parish's barrows.
- Fåre, Lex: the town, its station and the name.
- Fund og Fortidsminder: the records linked above, and the orthophoto, 1842-99 and 1901-71 maps and cadastral layer (Kort © SDFI).
- Your hunting-app screenshot of the three parcels (Septima, © KDS), and your Fund og Fortidsminder and Google Maps screenshots.